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SECTION 01

BRIDGING DATA & DECISIONS: THE ROLE OF DATA GOVERNANCE AND DATA MANAGEMENT IN MODERN BUSINESS INTELLIGENCE

INDUSTRY TALK: REPORT

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Introduction

The Industry Talk titled "Bridging Data & Decisions: The Role of Data Governance and Data Management in Modern Business Intelligence" which was conducted on 20th May 2026 was delivered by Mr. Faiz Fablillah, a Senior Practitioner in Data and AI Governance as well as a Certified Data Management Professional (CDMP) under DAMA International. The talk was focused on the importance of data governance and data management in today's evolving industry. Mr. Faiz Fablillah also explained why data governance matters, what data management and governance actually are, and how the industry is evolving with the integration of Artificial Intelligence (AI). The talk also highlighted the relevance of these concepts to future careers in the technology and business intelligence fields. Overall, the talk provided a better understanding of how proper data governance supports accurate decision-making, improves data quality, and helps organizations adapt to modern technological advancements.

Key Takeaways

Currently, Mr. Faiz Fablillah is a Senior Principal of Enterprise Data and AI Governance at PIDM, where he has 15+ years of experience in the financial services, manufacturing and oil and gas sectors. The main responsibilities of being in this role is to ensure the data is credible, on track and well documented before it becomes decision data. This includes collaborating with data owners in various departments, maintaining the data quality and verifying that the reports or dashboards sent up to senior management are accurate. Mr. Faiz is also a member of the Board of Directors of DAMA (Data Management) Malaysia. His path from data analyst to data science lead and now into governance highlights how the job of a data professional has transformed from being a mere technical job into having the responsibility of overseeing and managing an entire data ecosystem.

Mr. Faiz clarified that there's more to it than people realize when it comes to transforming raw data into an effective business decision. When it comes to the real Business Intelligence (BI) pipeline, it begins with hundreds of data sources which have to be cleaned, integrated, secured and reviewed for compliance before any dashboard can be created. Data Governance made the bridge between it messy, unverified data and trusted business insights by establishing rules on data ownership, accountability and quality. The importance of data lineage or the ability to trace data back to its source and understand how it's been changed is to build the stakeholder trust in any analytics output.

During the talk, several frameworks and technologies were discussed. The DAMA-DMBOK (Data Management Body of Knowledge) framework was introduced as the industry's best practice for data management, encompassing 11 areas such as data quality, metadata, data security and master data management. The six dimensions of data quality are completeness, accuracy, consistency, validity, uniqueness and timeliness as a practical approach to test data for use. Technology-wise that AI is now being utilized to automate tasks such as anomaly detection, data profiling and compliance Personal Identifiable Information (PII) detection. The agentic AI systems are able to perform governance activities without human intervention, permitting people to establish guidelines and approve major choices. Malaysia's PDPA (Personal Data Protection) regulations are cited as a real constraint in the business that requires due governance to be addressed.

The real-world case is when a Malaysian Bank faces discrepant information about customers in various systems. The bank's implementation of Master Data Management (MDM), automated data quality checks and centralized golden records resulted in a single customer view, a 40% reduction in regulatory risk and faster decision making. Next, there were more than 200 dashboards in a telco company which no one trusted. They were able to cut this down to 30 reliable dashboards and triple user adoption by implementing data lineage, quality score cards and a data catalog. In addition, a healthcare organization with 15 systems applied automated PII detection, intelligent access and audit trails to ensure full PDPA compliance without a single data breach. The examples proved that effective data governance provides business impact in various industries and this impact is real and measurable.

Reflection and Critical Insights

Our group finds that Mr Faiz's presentation is very interesting with his way of actively engaging with the students and explains everything in a layman language by not using jargon words. Mr Faiz keeps on implies about "Data is a by-product and not a system" which is his main grounding reality-check on the corporate conflict around raw data which is a very relevant contrast to what learnt in Business Intelligence (BI) class. This is because students are often handed pre-cleaned CSV files, creating a false impression that data is readily available for modeling, while this session discussed how the structure of the data needs to be laid out first. Moreover, Mr. Faiz also revealed that 73% of data remains dark and unused, coupled with the staggering financial losses associated with poor data quality, shifted our group's perspective on the true priorities of modern enterprises. In the current fast-paced corporate ecosystem, data governance is no longer an obstacle to the business as it is regarded as a key business enabler in the corporate world where the regulations such as the Personal Data Protection Act (PDPA), ensure that organisations are shielded from regulatory threats to their existence. Not to mention that this talk also reframed our perspective on our future professional landscape by introducing a rapidly expanding domain of emerging niche governance roles such as Data Governance Analysts, Data Stewards, and Data Quality Engineers. The talk inspired in several forward-looking areas, specifically regarding how Agentic AI can be safely integrated into automated metadata tagging without introducing algorithmic biases which also motivate us to explore professional certification pathways, such as the Certified Data Management Professional (CDMP) credential, to gain a distinct competitive edge in the job market.

Conclusion

To conclude, this talk has effectively bridged the combination of BI with the essential governance framework that is required in modern enterprise organisations. The session not just delivered an impactful reality check but also an eye opener regarding the dashboard that without proper management it will not become a high quality asset to an organization. Besides, large scale industries like banking, telecom, and even the healthcare sector deal with their data by following the regulations by maintaining the data quality and also the PDPA compliance has shifted our perspective on merely building visualisations. Not to mention that the talk has also inspired everyone to pursue specialized paths like the CDMP credential and explore automated governance through Agentic AI.